



THE

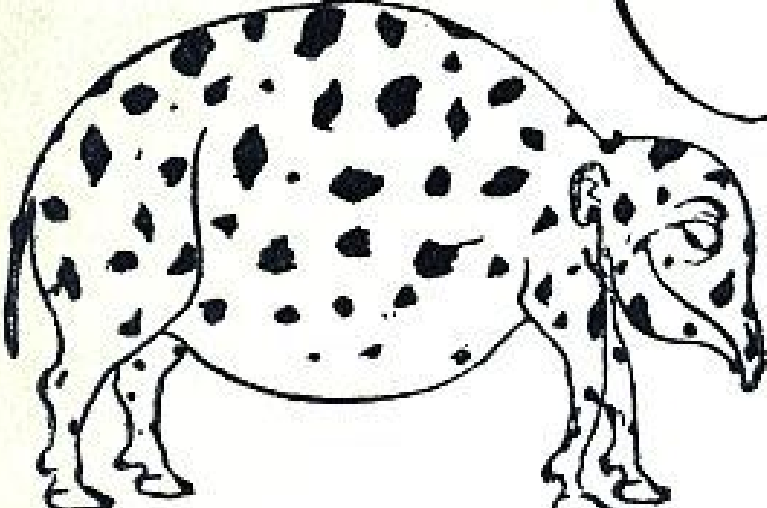


BAD CHILD'S  
BOOK OF  
BEASTS



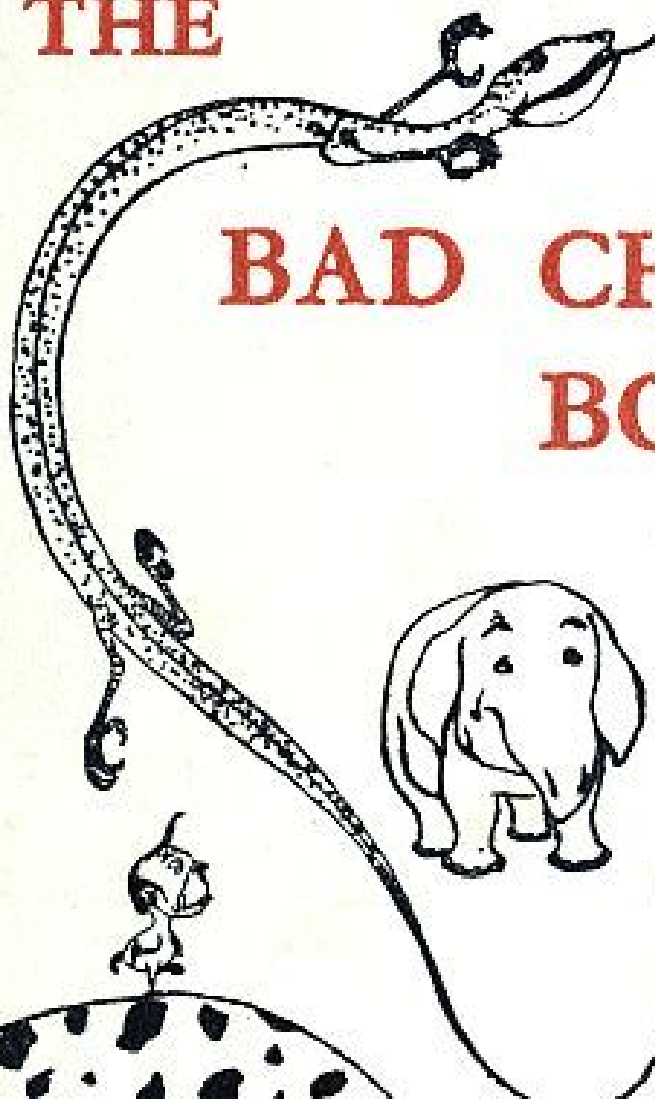
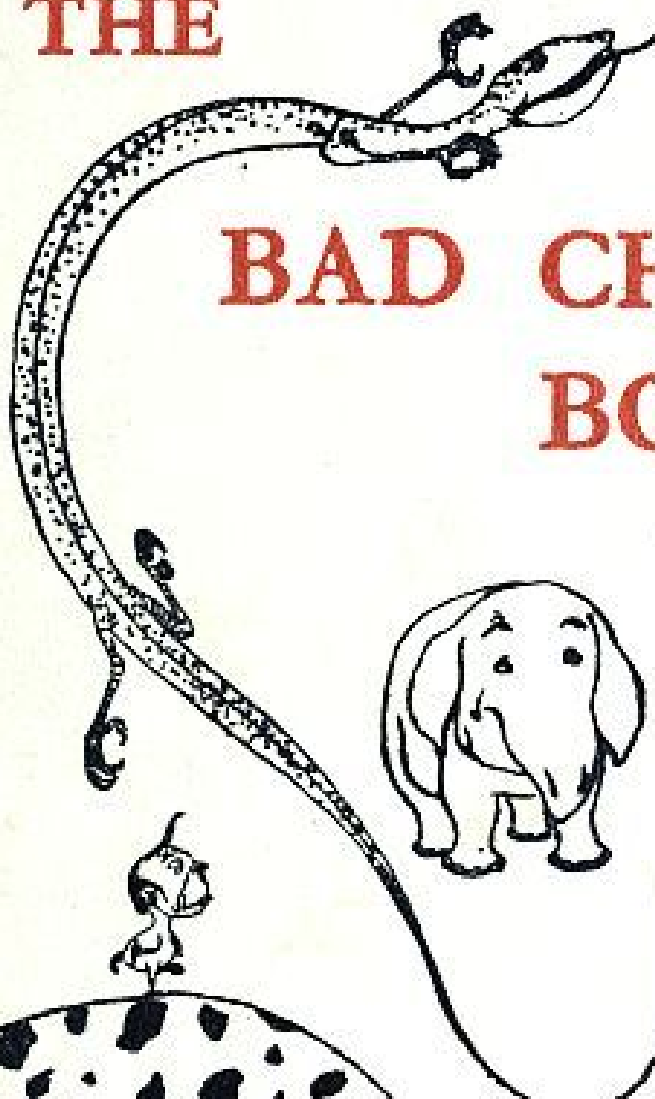
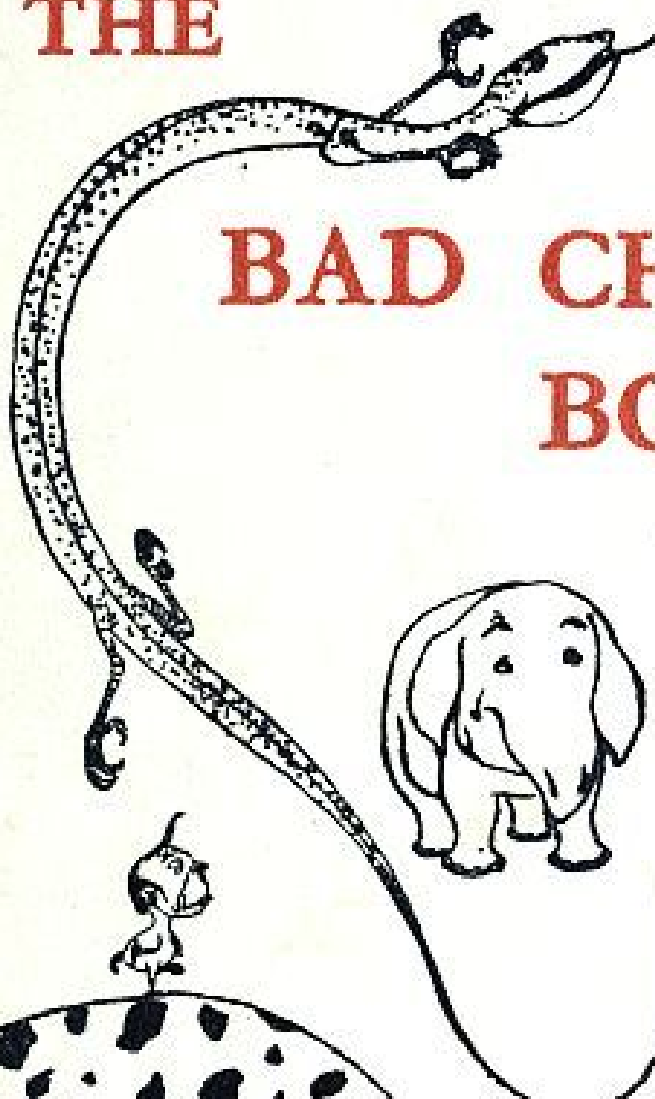
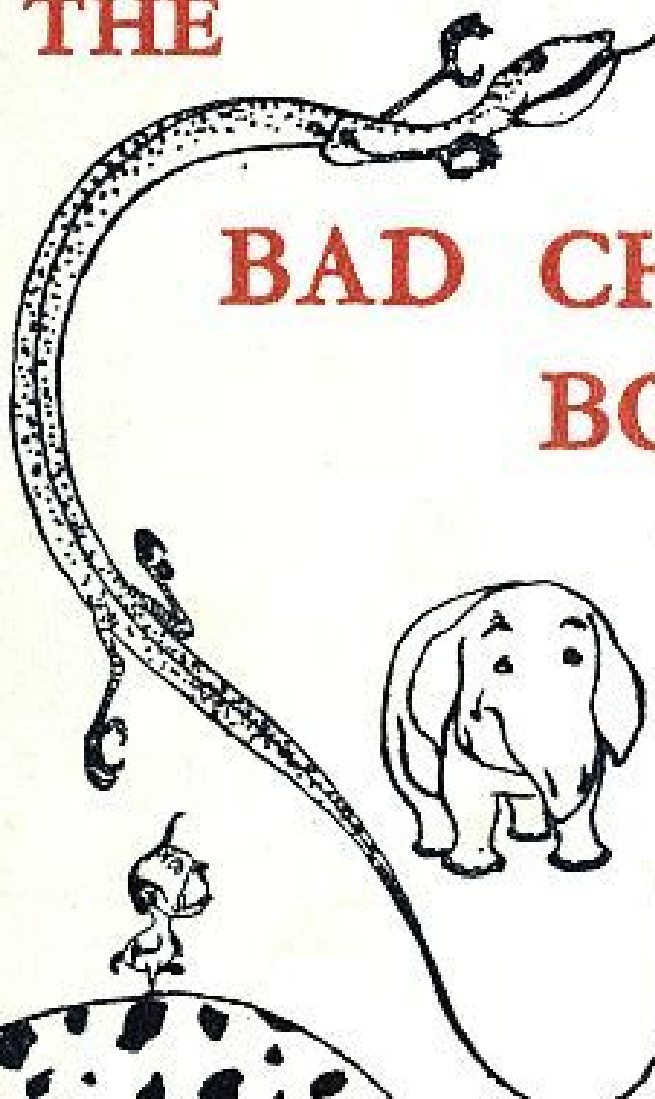
Verses by  
**H. BELLOC**

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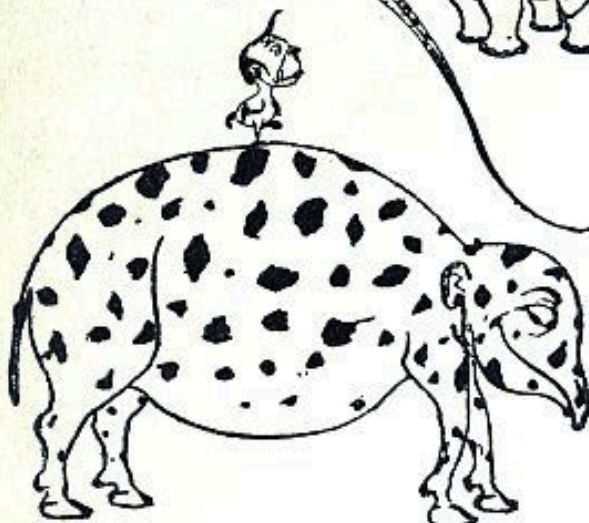
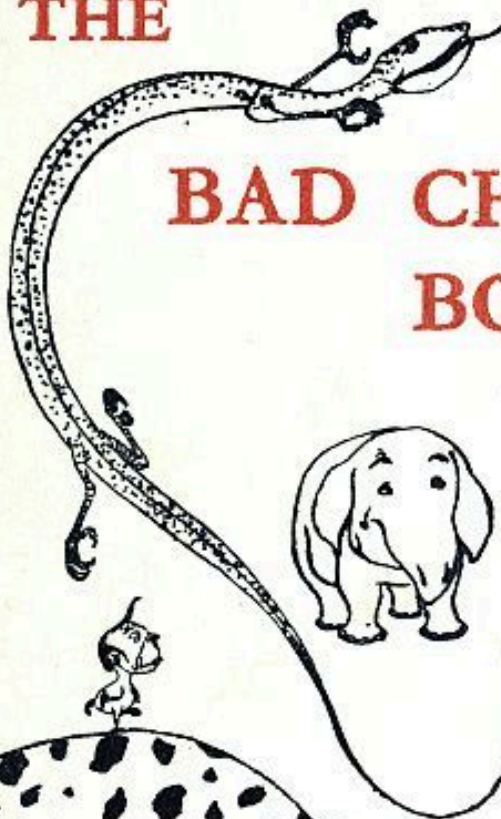
3 HENRIETTA STREET, COVENT GARDEN





**THE**

**BAD CHILD'S  
BOOK OF  
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**H. BELLOC**

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**DUCKWORTH,**  
3 HENRIETTA STREET, COVENT GARDEN

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**THE  
BAD CHILD'S  
BOOK OF  
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**Verses by**

**H. BELLOC**

**Pictures by**

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DUCKWORTH,  
3 HENRIETTA STREET, COVENT GARDEN

Child! do not throw this book about;  
Refrain from the unholy pleasure  
Of cutting all the pictures out!  
Preserve it as your chiefest treasure.

Child, have you never heard it said  
That you are heir to all the ages?  
Why, then, your hands were never made  
To tear these beautiful thick pages!

Your little hands were made to take  
The better things and leave the worse ones.  
They also may be used to shake  
The Massive Paws of Elder Persons.

And when your prayers complete the day,  
Darling, your little tiny hands  
Were also made, I think, to pray  
For men that lose their fairylands.

*Made and Printed in Great Britain by The Camelot Press Limited, London and Southampton*

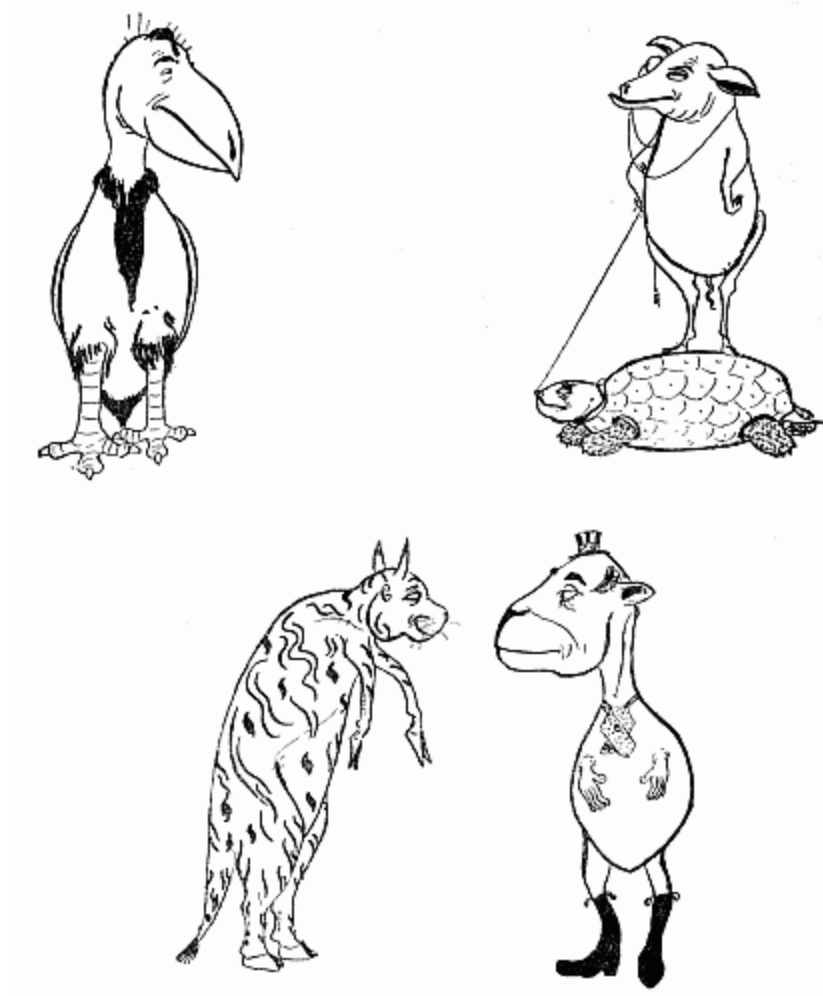
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**DEDICATION**



To  
Master EVELYN BELL  
Of Oxford

Evelyn Bell,  
I love you well.



---

# INTRODUCTION

I CALL you bad, my little child,  
Upon the title page,  
Because a manner rude and wild  
Is common at your age.

The Moral of this priceless work  
(If rightly understood)  
Will make you—from a little Turk—  
Unnaturally good.

Do not as evil children do,  
Who on the slightest grounds  
Will imitate



the Kangaroo,  
With wild unmeaning bounds:

Do not as children badly bred,  
Who eat like little Hogs,  
And when they have to go to bed



Will whine like Puppy Dogs:

Who take their manners from the Ape,  
Their habits from the Bear,  
Indulge the loud unseemly jape,  
And never brush their hair.

But so control your actions that  
Your friends may all repeat.

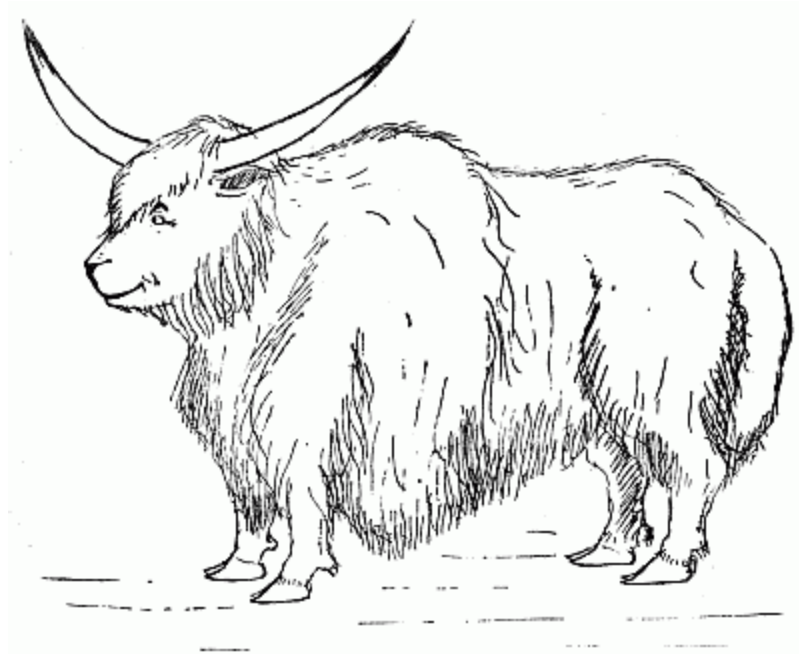


'This child is dainty as the Cat,  
And as the Owl discreet.'

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# The Yak

As a friend to the children



commend me the

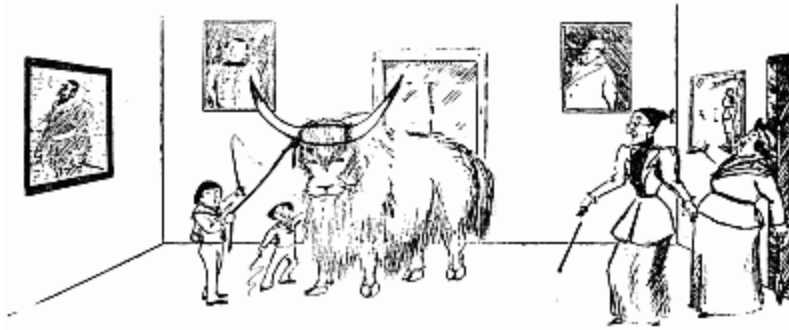
Yak.

You will find it exactly the thing:  
It will carry and fetch,



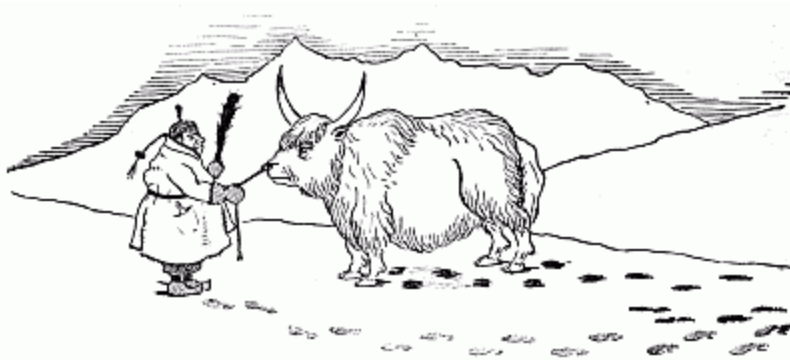
you can ride on its

back,  
Or lead it about



with a string.

The Tartar who dwells on the plains of Thibet  
(A desolate region of snow)



Has for centuries made it a nursery pet,  
And surely the Tartar should know!

Then tell your papa where the Yak can be  
got,



And if he is awfully rich  
He will buy you the creature—

or else



he will *not*.

(I cannot be positive which.)

---

# The Polar Bear

The Polar Bear is unaware



Of cold that cuts me through:  
For why? He has a coat of hair.  
I wish I had one too!

---

# The Lion

The Lion, the Lion, he dwells in the waste,  
He has a big head and a very small waist;



But his shoulders are stark, and his jaws they  
are grim,  
And a good little child will not play with  
him.

---

# The Tiger

The Tiger on the other hand,



is kittenish and

mild,

He makes a pretty playfellow for any little  
child;

And mothers of large families (who claim to  
common sense)

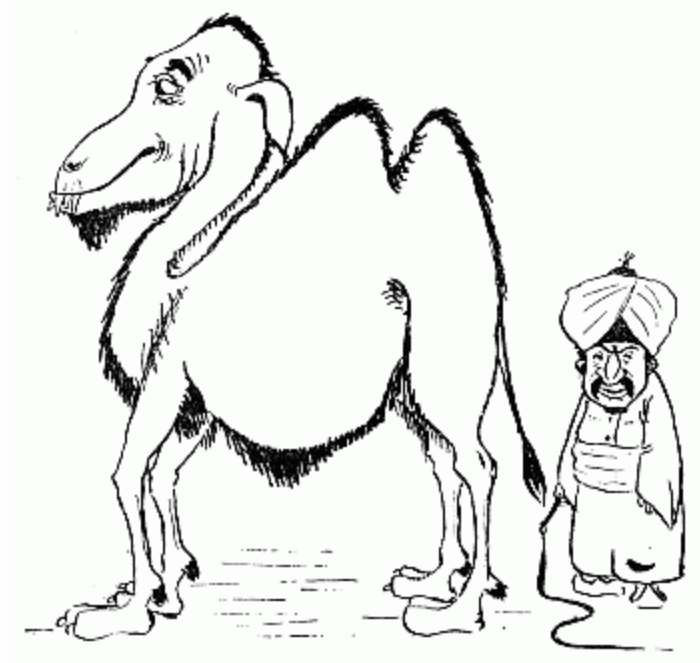


Will find a Tiger well repay the trouble and  
expense.

---

# The Dromedary

The Dromedary is a cheerful bird:

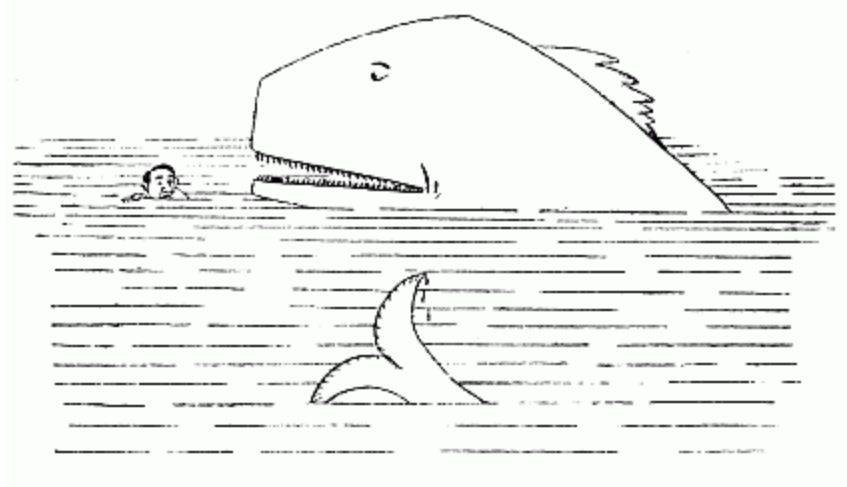


I cannot say the same about the Kurd.

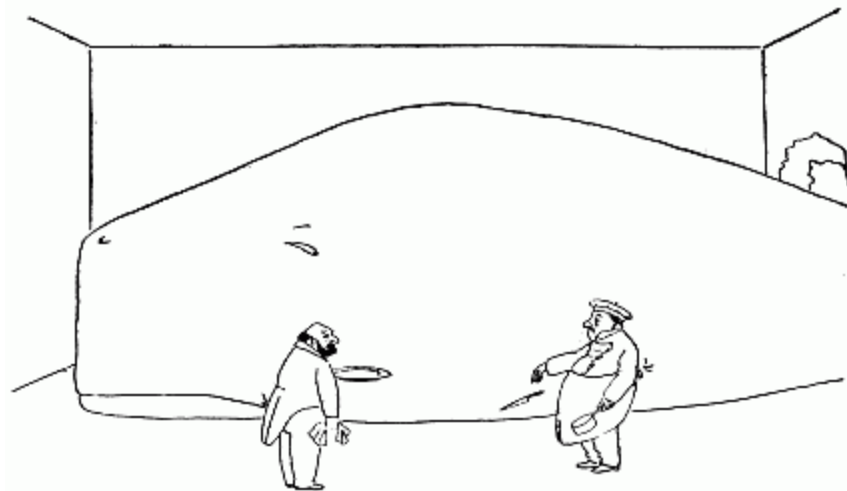
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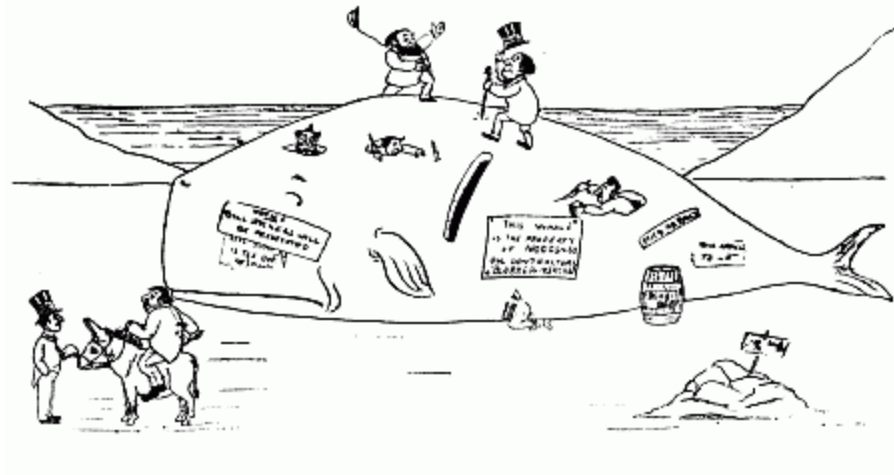
# The Whale



The Whale that wanders round the Pole  
Is not



a table fish.  
You cannot bake or boil him whole  
Nor serve him in a dish;



But you may cut his blubber up  
And melt it down for oil.  
And so replace



the colza bean  
(A product of the soil).

These facts should all be noted down  
And ruminated on,



By every boy in Oxford town  
Who wants to be a Don.

---

# The Camel



"The Ship of the Desert."

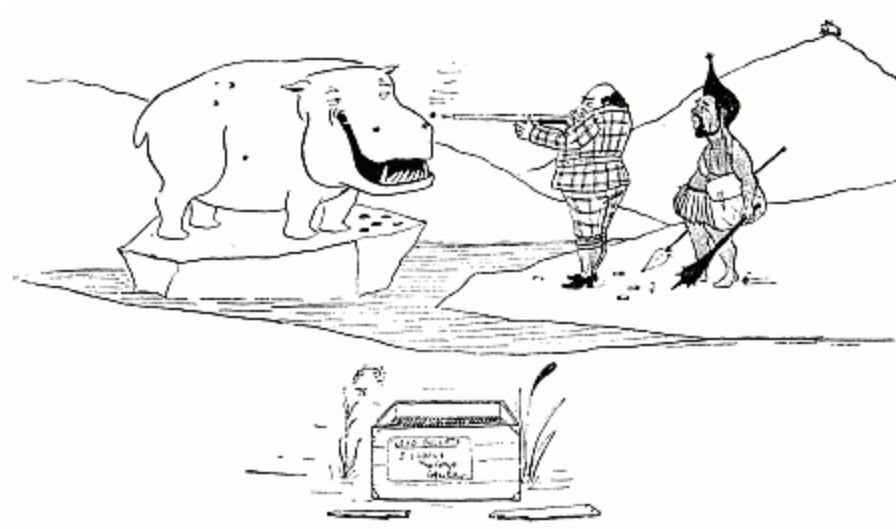
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# The Hippopotamus

I shoot the Hippopotamus



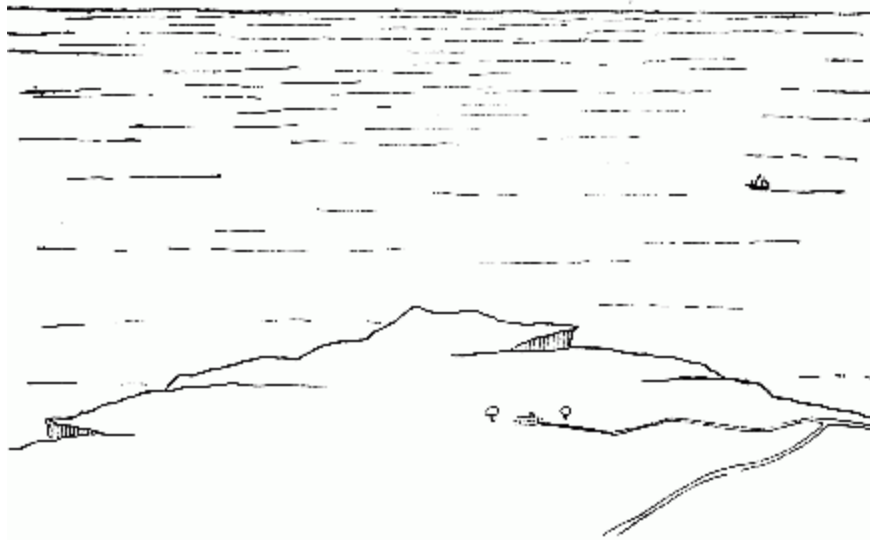
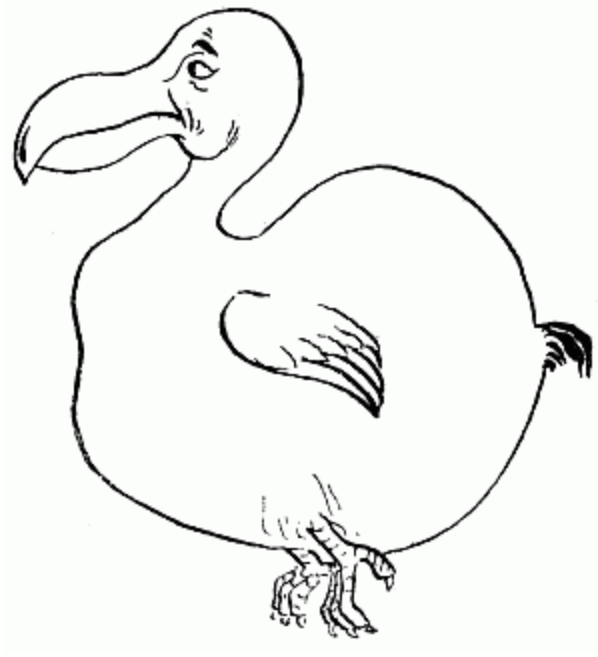
with bullets made of platinum,  
Because if I use leaden ones



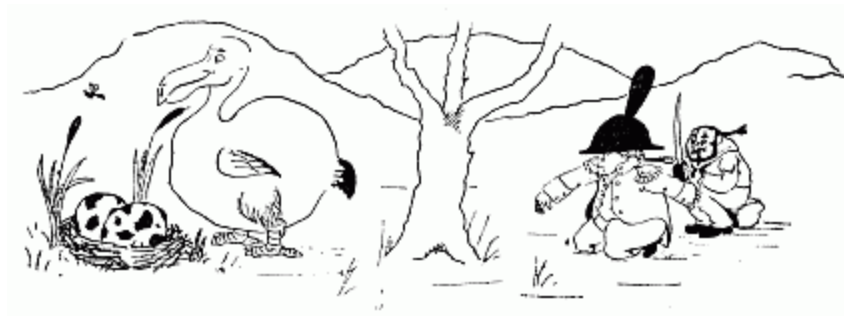
his hide is sure to flatten 'em.

---

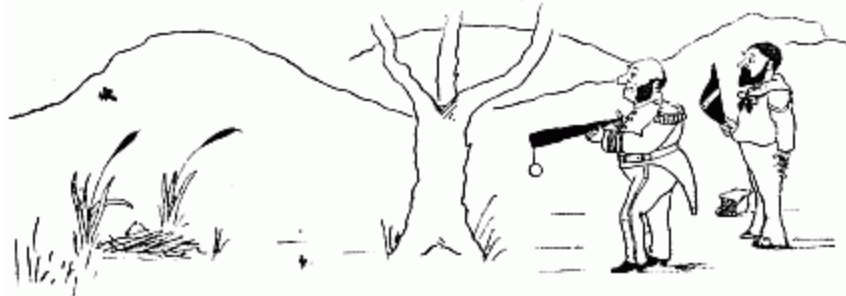
# The Dodo



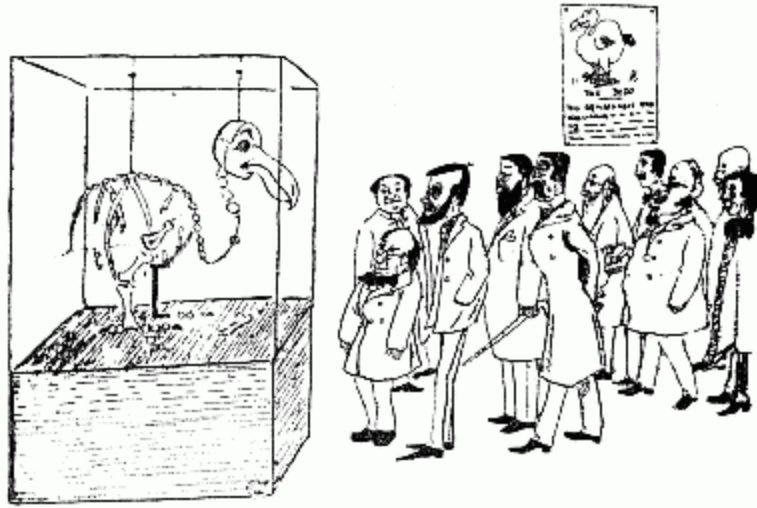
The Dodo used  
to walk around,



And take the sun and air.  
The sun yet warms his native ground—  
The Dodo is not there!



The voice which used to squawk and squeak  
Is now for ever dumb—



Yet may you see his bones and beak  
All in the Mu-se-um.

---

# The Marmozet

The species Man and Marmozet  
Are intimately linked;



The Marmozet survives as yet,  
But Men are all extinct.

---



# The Camelopard



The Camelopard, it is said  
By travellers (who never lie),  
He cannot stretch out straight in bed  
Because he is so high.  
The clouds surround his lofty head,  
His hornlets touch the sky.

How shall  
I hunt  
I



this quadruped?  
cannot tell!  
Not I!

(A picture of how people try  
And fail to hit that head so high.)

I'll buy a little parachute  
(A common parachute with wings),  
I'll fill it full of arrowroot  
And other necessary things,



And I will slay this fearful brute  
With stones and sticks and guns and slings.

(A picture of



how people shoot  
With comfort from a parachute.)

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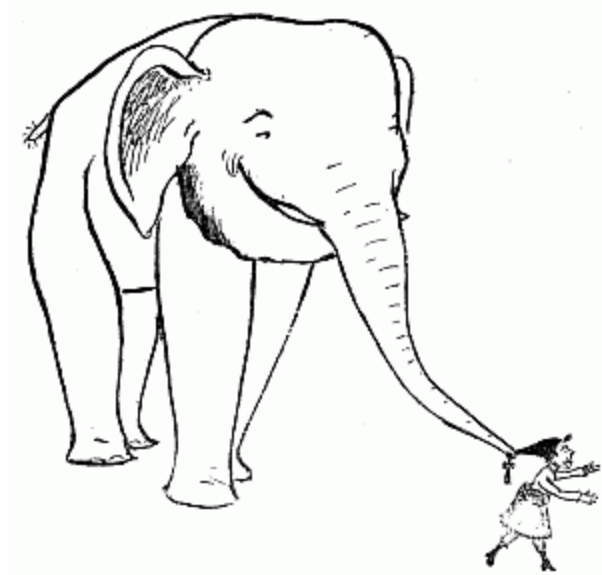
## The Learned Fish



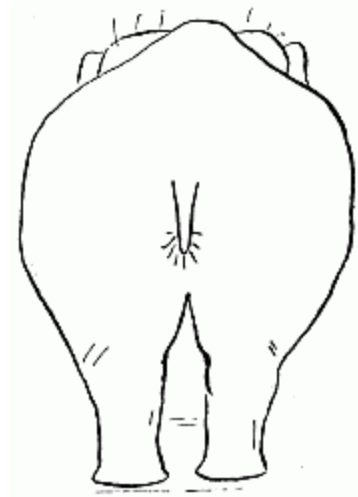
This learned Fish has not sufficient brains  
To go into the water when it rains.

---

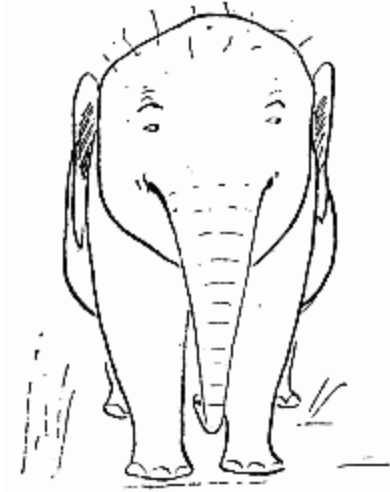
# The Elephant



When people call this beast to mind,  
They marvel more and more  
At such a



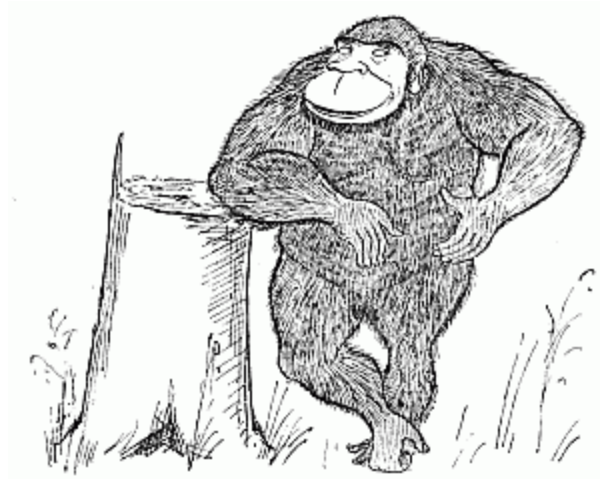
*LITTLE* tail behind,



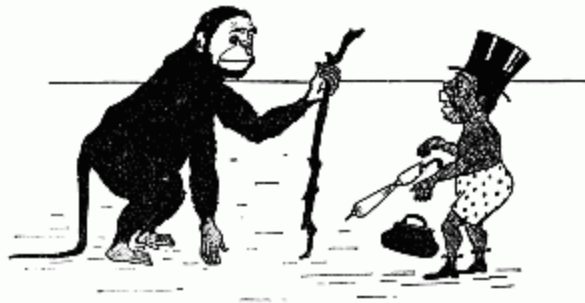
So *LARGE* a trunk before.

---

# The Big Baboon



The Big Baboon is found upon  
The plains of Cariboo:  
He goes about



with nothing on  
(A shocking thing to do).

But if he



dressed respectably  
And let his whiskers grow,  
How like this Big Baboon would be



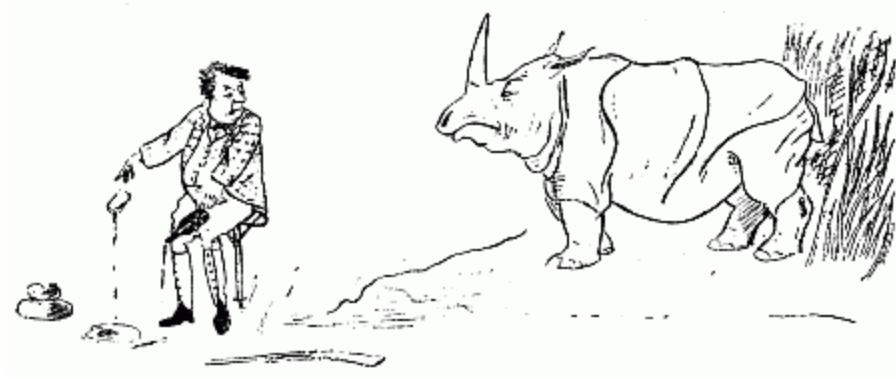
To Mister So-and-so!

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# The Rhinoceros

Rhinoceros, your hide looks all undone,



You do not take my fancy in the least:



You have a horn where other brutes have none:

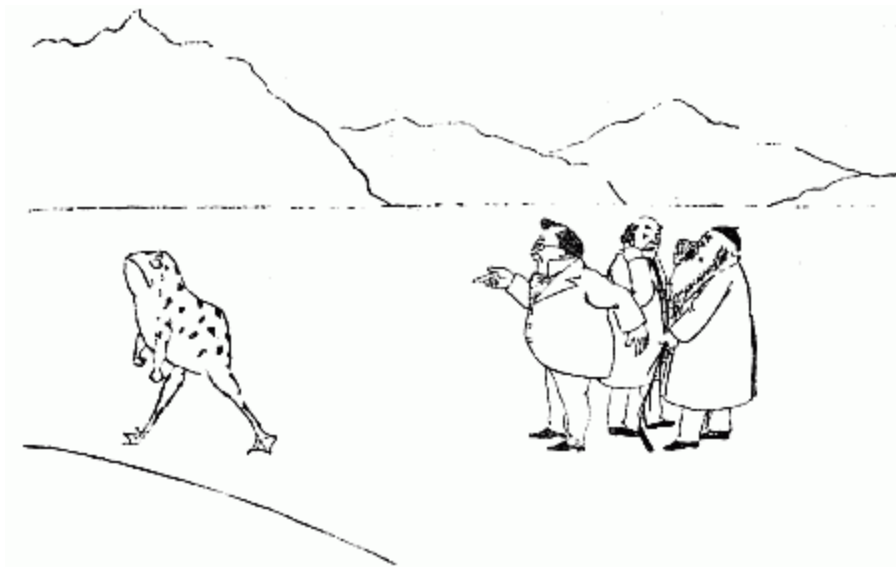
Rhinoceros, you are an ugly beast.

---

# The Frog

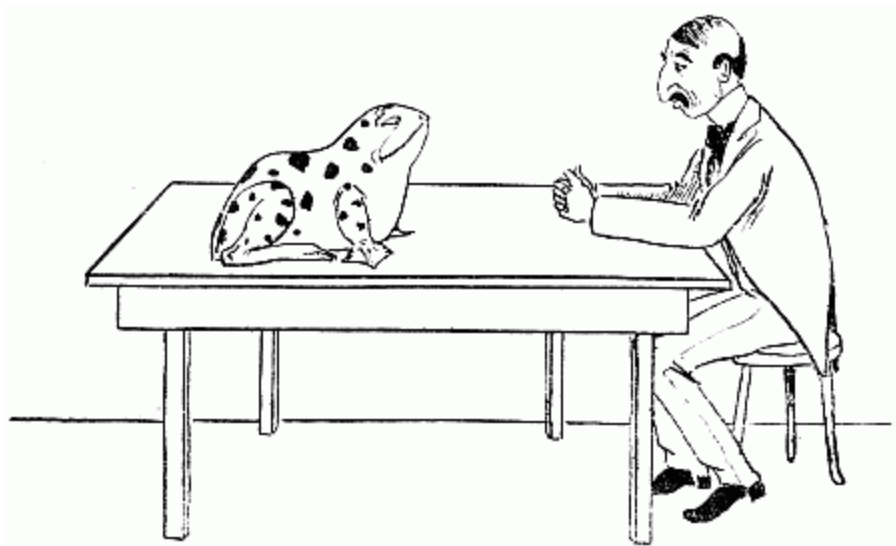


Be kind and tender to the Frog,  
And do not call him names,  
As 'Slimy skin,' or 'Polly-wog,'  
Or likewise 'Ugly James,'  
Or 'Gap-a-grin,' or 'Toad-gone-wrong,'  
Or 'Bill Bandy-knees':

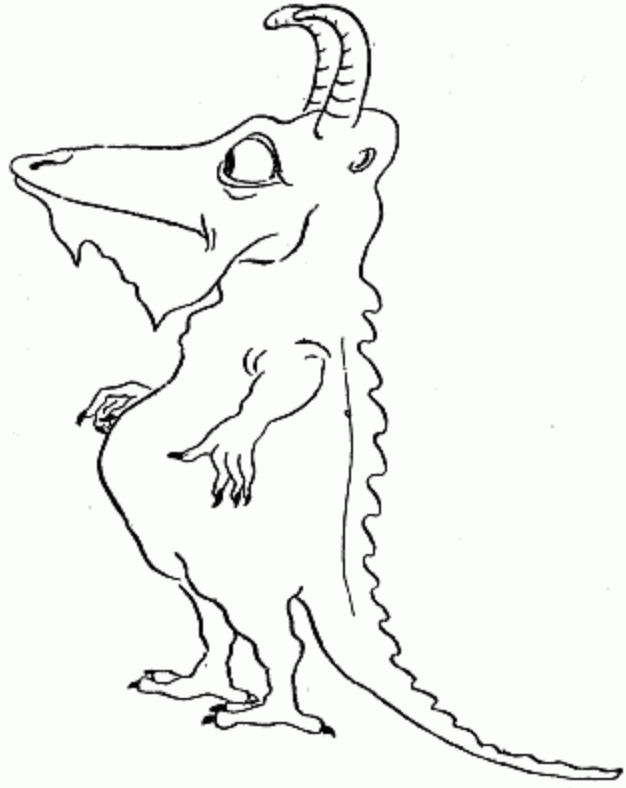


The Frog is justly sensitive  
To epithets like these.

No animal will more repay  
A treatment kind and fair;  
At least



so lonely people say  
Who keep a frog (and, by the way,  
They are extremely rare).



Oh! My!

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CHILD'S BOOK OF BEASTS \*\*\*

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